

IAD-Risk: Risk-Aware Identity-Agenda Disentanglement for Scholarly Work Deduplication

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Abstract

Scholarly entity matching must distinguish whether two records describe the same work, not merely whether they discuss the same research agenda. Modern scientific representations and pair classifiers often improve semantic matching, but a high semantic score can also connect different papers in the same task, benchmark, or citation community. This paper studies this failure mode as *identity-agenda confusion* and proposes IAD-Risk, a risk-aware framework that separates identity evidence from agenda evidence before making merge decisions. IAD-Risk combines stratified data provenance, identity and agenda relation heads, and false-merge risk gating to prevent agenda-level hard negatives from entering automatic merge clusters. We evaluate the framework with IAD-Bench, a benchmark contract that separates DeepMatcher gold labels, SciRepEval/SciDocs-style proxy labels, and OpenAlex/OpenCitations silver hard negatives. On IAD-Bench-Open-v2, transformer-backed IAD-Risk variants retain high same-work performance while reducing hard-negative false merges that affect single-space scientific representation baselines. The results support a conservative conclusion: identity-agenda disentanglement is a practical mechanism for safer scholarly deduplication, while additional manual validation and broader source-heldout validation remain necessary before making broad method-ranking claims.

1 Introduction

Scholarly knowledge systems rely on entity matching to decide whether multiple records describe the same scientific work. Digital libraries, literature review tools, citation graphs, recommender systems, and evidence synthesis pipelines all require stable work identities because a false merge can combine evidence from different papers and distort downstream analysis. This paper focuses on scholarly work deduplication: given two scholarly records with titles, abstracts, authors, venues, identifiers, topics, and citations, the system must decide whether the records can be safely merged as the same work.

The central challenge is that topical similarity is not identity evidence. Two papers can share a task, dataset, method family, citation neighborhood, or OpenAlex topic while making different contributions. Scientific representation models such as SPECTER and SciNCL are valuable because they bring related papers close in embedding space [2, 9], but the same behavior can create false-merge risk when a deduplication system treats semantic closeness as work identity. This failure is particularly important in scholarly settings because false merges are harder to repair than missed duplicates: once distinct papers are clustered as one work, citation counts, recommendation signals, and review evidence can be contaminated.

We formulate this failure mode as identity-agenda confusion. Identity refers to whether two records denote the same scholarly work. Agenda refers to whether two records discuss the same research problem, benchmark, method family, or citation community. Existing entity matching methods [3, 5, 8] typically optimize pair classification, while scholarly document representation

methods optimize semantic relatedness. Neither objective alone forces the model to learn that same-agenda pairs can be high-risk non-identities.

We propose IAD-Risk, a risk-aware identity-agenda disentanglement framework for scholarly work deduplication. IAD-Risk learns separate relation signals for same-work identity, same-agenda relatedness, and agenda-non-identity hard negatives, then derives a false-merge risk score from these signals. A pair is eligible for automatic merging only when identity evidence is sufficiently strong and agenda-non-identity risk remains below a merge threshold. This selective decision rule turns deduplication from a high-recall similarity problem into a risk-calibrated safety problem.

The paper makes three contributions. First, it defines identity-agenda confusion as a targeted failure mode in scholarly entity matching and introduces hard-negative false-merge rate as a safety metric. Second, it presents IAD-Bench, a provenance-aware benchmark contract that keeps gold, proxy, silver, LLM-silver, and human-reviewed labels separate. Third, it evaluates IAD-Risk under the same pair contract used by representation and entity-matching baselines, while keeping additional LLM and clustering interfaces as reproducible extensions rather than unsupported primary evidence. The current evidence supports targeted false-merge suppression under stratified evaluation; it does not support a broad method-ranking claim or a claim that silver labels replace human gold.

2 Related Work

Entity matching and record linkage provide the classical foundation for deciding whether records refer to the same real-world entity [3]. Deep learning methods have extended this line by learning pair representations and matching functions from labeled examples [5, 8]. Transformer pair encoders such as RoBERTa [6] provide a practical implementation of this pair-classification paradigm. These systems are strong baselines for scholarly deduplication, but their standard formulation usually treats each pair as a same-entity classification problem and does not explicitly model agenda-level hard negatives or label-provenance boundaries.

Scientific document representation methods learn embeddings that capture citation, topical, and semantic relatedness. SPECTER uses citation-informed supervision to learn document-level representations and introduced SciDocs as a document-level evaluation benchmark [2]. SciNCL further improves scientific representations with neighborhood contrastive learning [9], and SciRepEval broadens scientific representation evaluation across multiple task formats while releasing the SPECTER2 model family [11]. These methods are appropriate baselines because they capture scientific relatedness, yet their strength is also a risk for deduplication: a representation that intentionally brings related papers close can over-connect papers that share an agenda but are not the same work.

Scientific language resources and open corpora make it possible to build reproducible scholarly NLP systems at scale. SciBERT shows that domain-specific pretraining on scientific text improves scientific NLP tasks [1], while S2ORC provides a large open corpus with metadata, abstracts, references, and full text for many open-access papers [7]. These resources motivate the use of scientific text and citation signals in scholarly matching, but they do not by themselves distinguish work identity from topical relatedness.

Open scholarly metadata sources enable reproducible benchmark construction, but their signals must be interpreted carefully. OpenAlex provides a large open index of scholarly works and concepts [10], and OpenCitations provides open citation data [4]. These sources are useful for constructing agenda-level hard negatives through shared topics or references. However, such labels are silver evidence, not human gold. IAD-Bench therefore treats data provenance as part of the experimental

protocol rather than as bookkeeping.

3 Problem Formulation

Let d_i and d_j be two scholarly records. The target identity label y_{ij}^I indicates whether the records describe the same scholarly work. The agenda label y_{ij}^A indicates whether the records discuss a related research agenda. A hard negative is a pair with high agenda evidence but negative identity evidence:

$$y_{ij}^A = 1, \quad y_{ij}^I = 0.$$

This pair should not be merged even if the documents are semantically close.

We evaluate merge safety with hard-negative false-merge rate:

$$\text{HNFMR} = \frac{\#\{(i, j) : \hat{m}_{ij} = 1, y_{ij}^A = 1, y_{ij}^I = 0\}}{\#\{(i, j) : y_{ij}^A = 1, y_{ij}^I = 0\}},$$

where $\hat{m}_{ij}$ is the automatic merge decision. The goal is not only to maximize same-work F1, but also to control HNFMR under explicit evidence provenance.

3.1 Notation and Relation Semantics

Table 1 summarizes the notation used throughout the paper. The key distinction is that identity variables describe whether two records denote the same work, while agenda variables describe topical or citation-level relatedness. This distinction prevents a high relatedness score from being interpreted as direct merge evidence.

Table 1: Notation and relation semantics. The paper uses separate symbols for identity, agenda relatedness, agenda-non-identity risk, and merge decisions.

Symbol or field	Meaning	Role in evaluation
d_i, d_j	Two scholarly records.	Input pair for scoring and merge decisions.
y_{ij}^I	Identity label: the records describe the same work.	Gold identity evidence when supported by the label source.
y_{ij}^A	Agenda label: the records share a research agenda.	Proxy or silver relatedness evidence, not sufficient for merging.
y_{ij}^{ANI}	Agenda-non-identity label.	Hard-negative supervision for pairs that are related but should not merge.
p_{work}	Predicted same-work probability.	Positive merge evidence.
p_{agenda}	Predicted agenda-relatedness probability.	Relatedness evidence that can increase risk when identity is weak.
p_{ani}	Predicted agenda-non-identity probability.	Direct risk evidence against automatic merging.
p_{risk}	Derived false-merge risk score.	Gate for rejecting or deferring risky pairs.
$\hat{m}_{ij}$	Automatic merge decision.	Determines FMR and HNFMR.
label strength	Gold, proxy, silver, LLM-silver, or manual validation layer.	Controls how a row can be used in training, evaluation, and claims.

4 IAD-Bench

IAD-Bench is a benchmark contract for organizing scholarly pair evidence. It is not a claim that every label has the same evidential status. Each pair stores relation labels, expected identity labels, expected agenda labels, label source, label strength, provenance, split, and hard-negative level.

Table 2: IAD-Bench label layers. Gold, proxy, and silver labels are reported separately to avoid overstating evidence strength.

Layer	Source	Use in this paper
Gold	DeepMatcher / py_entitymatching	Same-work identity evaluation
Proxy	SciRepEval / SciDocs-style proximity	Same-agenda analysis
Silver	OpenAlex / OpenCitations	Agenda-non-identity hard negatives
LLM-silver	LLM pair judgments	Auxiliary analysis and baseline
Manual validation	Independent human review	External validation target

The Open-v2 benchmark variant used in the core evidence combines 415 DeepMatcher gold pairs with 10,000 OpenAlex-derived silver hard negatives, producing 10,415 pair records over 1,737 documents. The DeepMatcher component provides same-work gold labels, while the OpenAlex component stresses same-agenda non-identity behavior. This design is intentionally conservative: OpenAlex and OpenCitations are used to expose false-merge risk, not to replace human gold.

5 Method

5.1 Overview

IAD-Risk converts scholarly deduplication into selective risk-aware matching. Given a candidate pair, the model estimates identity, agenda, and agenda-non-identity signals, then derives a false-merge risk score. The final merge decision is made only when identity evidence exceeds a same-work threshold and risk evidence remains below blocking thresholds. Figure 1 summarizes the workflow.

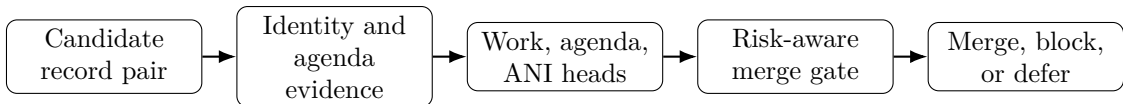


Figure 1: IAD-Risk pipeline. The framework first separates identity evidence from agenda evidence, then predicts relation signals and derives a false-merge risk score before applying a conservative merge gate.

5.2 Identity and Agenda Signals

IAD-Risk separates the representation space into identity-oriented and agenda-oriented evidence. Identity evidence includes strong identifiers, near-duplicate titles, author overlap, year and venue agreement, and work-level metadata. Agenda evidence includes shared research topics, similar abstracts, citation neighborhoods, shared references, and scientific representation similarity. The separation is necessary because the same feature can have different meanings: high embedding similarity may indicate same work, but it may also indicate two different papers in the same research area.

5.3 Multi-Task Relation Heads

The model predicts three pair-level relation quantities: p_{work} , p_{agenda} , and p_{ani} . The same-work head estimates identity. The same-agenda head estimates topical relatedness. The agenda-non-identity head detects pairs that are related but should not be merged. The false-merge risk score is then derived from these heads:

$$p_{\text{risk}} = \max\{p_{\text{ani}}, p_{\text{agenda}}(1 - p_{\text{work}})\}.$$

This construction makes the safety signal high when a pair is explicitly predicted as agenda-non-identity, or when it is agenda-related but lacks strong identity evidence.

5.4 Training Objective

The learning objective combines identity, agenda, and agenda-non-identity supervision without treating every source as the same label type; the false-merge risk score is derived after the relation heads are estimated. For a pair (i, j) , the model minimizes

$$\mathcal{L}_{ij} = \lambda_w \text{CE}(y_{ij}^I, p_{\text{work}}) + \lambda_a \text{CE}(y_{ij}^A, p_{\text{agenda}}) + \lambda_n \text{CE}(y_{ij}^{ANI}, p_{\text{ani}}),$$

where CE is binary cross-entropy and $\lambda_w, \lambda_a, \lambda_n$ control the contribution of each supervision channel. The key design choice is provenance-aware masking: a pair contributes only to the heads for which its label source is valid. For example, DeepMatcher pairs supervise same-work identity, whereas OpenAlex/OpenCitations silver hard negatives supervise agenda-non-identity risk without being promoted to human gold identity labels.

5.5 Risk-Aware Merge Decision

The merge policy is:

$$\hat{m}_{ij} = 1 \quad \text{iff} \quad p_{\text{work}} \geq \tau_w, \quad p_{\text{ani}} < \tau_a, \quad p_{\text{risk}} < \tau_r, \quad \text{cannot_link}_{ij} = 0.$$

This rule is deliberately selective. It can reject or defer high-risk pairs instead of forcing every semantically related pair into a binary match decision. The same decision interface also supports constrained union-find clustering, where cannot-link evidence prevents transitive false merges.

5.6 Failure-Control Rationale

IAD-Risk is designed as a failure-control framework rather than as another similarity scorer. Table 3 summarizes how each design choice addresses a specific false-merge pathway. The table also states the remaining boundary for each control, because a safety mechanism should make its unsupported cases explicit.

Table 3: Failure-control rationale of IAD-Risk. Each component targets a concrete way in which agenda-level similarity can be mistaken for work identity.

Failure pathway	Design response	Remaining boundary
Topically close papers receive high semantic similarity.	Separate agenda evidence from identity evidence before the merge gate.	Requires the benchmark to include agenda-level hard negatives.
Silver metadata is treated as if it were human gold.	Preserve label strength and provenance, and mask supervision by valid label source.	Silver labels support stress testing, not exhaustive truth claims.
Pairwise errors contaminate clusters through transitivity.	Apply risk gating before constrained union-find and respect cannot-link evidence.	Cluster-level guarantees require complete cannot-link coverage.
Thresholds turn a classifier into an unsafe automatic merger.	Expose work, ANI, and risk thresholds and evaluate held-out merge decisions.	Threshold transfer should be rechecked under new source distributions.
Auxiliary LLM or proxy labels are over-interpreted.	Keep auxiliary rows separate unless traceable execution logs and artifact records exist.	LLM rows remain non-human evidence even when reproducible.

5.7 Implementation Details

The reported transformer variants use frozen scientific document encoders rather than end-to-end fine-tuning. For each candidate pair, the implementation builds three feature groups: identity features combine transformer distances with identifiers, author overlap, venue, and year signals; agenda features combine semantic similarity with topic and citation overlap; agenda-non-identity features add conflict indicators such as different identifiers and year conflict. The three relation heads are trained on the training split, and the merge policy exposes τ_w , τ_a , and τ_r as configurable thresholds. Unless a validation protocol overrides them, the implementation uses 0.5 for all three thresholds.

5.8 Feature and Head Specification

The implementation uses label provenance for supervision control, not as a predictive shortcut. Pair metadata such as label source, label strength, provenance, split, and hard-negative level are copied to prediction outputs for auditing, but they are excluded from the identity, agenda, and risk feature groups used by the relation heads. Table 4 gives the implementation-level contract used by the reported transformer variants.

Table 4: Feature and head specification for IAD-Risk transformer variants. Metadata fields are retained for auditing but are not used as model features.

Head or stage	Main input fields	Supervision or calculation	Output role
Identity head	Transformer distances, title similarity, author overlap, first-author match, venue similarity, year match, DOI/arXiv/OpenAlex identifier agreement.	Same-work labels from valid identity evidence, with provenance-aware masking.	Estimates p_{work} as positive merge evidence.
Agenda head	Transformer cosine, title and venue similarity, OpenAlex-style topic overlap, reference Jaccard similarity, year-distance score.	Same-agenda proxy or silver evidence when the source supports agenda relatedness.	Estimates p_{agenda} as relatedness evidence, not direct merge evidence.
ANI risk head	Transformer distances, title and author signals, topic overlap, reference overlap, year conflict, identifier agreement, and different-identifier conflicts.	Agenda-non-identity hard negatives from valid hard-negative sources.	Estimates p_{ani} as direct blocking evidence.
Risk gate	p_{work} , p_{agenda} , p_{ani} , τ_w , τ_a , τ_r , and cannot-link flags.	Computes $p_{\text{risk}} = \max\{p_{\text{ani}}, p_{\text{agenda}}(1 - p_{\text{work}})\}$.	Emits merge, block, or defer decisions.
Audit metadata	Pair ID, source pair ID, label strength, label source, provenance, split, and hard-negative level.	Copied from pair records and result artifacts.	Supports artifact review; it is not a training feature.

6 Experiments

6.1 Dataset Construction and Evidence Strength

Open-v2 is built by converting public scholarly metadata into a unified pair schema. Deep-Matcher/py_entitymatching records provide the same-work gold layer, while OpenAlex topics and OpenCitations-style citation signals provide agenda-level silver hard negatives. Each pair keeps its label strength, provenance, split, and hard-negative flag so that a gold identity result is never averaged with a silver stress-test result without being identified as such.

The benchmark therefore has two roles. The gold layer measures ordinary duplicate matching ability, and the silver hard-negative layer measures whether a system over-merges topically close but distinct papers. This separation is important for interpreting the results: a representation baseline can look useful for scientific retrieval while still being unsafe for automatic work identity merging.

6.2 Experimental Questions

The experiments ask four questions. RQ1 tests whether IAD-Risk preserves same-work matching performance on gold labels. RQ2 tests whether it reduces false merges on agenda-level hard negatives. RQ3 examines whether the observed behavior is consistent with the proposed risk mechanism. RQ4 tests whether results remain interpretable under gold, proxy, and silver label strata.

Table 5: Evaluation protocol. Each question is tied to a label stratum and a metric so that evidence strength is not mixed across sources.

Question	Evidence layer	Primary metric	Interpretation
RQ1	Gold identity pairs	Same-work F1	Duplicate matching ability
RQ2	Silver hard negatives	HNFMFMR	False-merge safety
RQ3	Mechanism analysis	FMR and HNFMR	Role of risk signals
RQ4	Gold/proxy/silver strata	Split metrics	Provenance-aware robustness

6.3 Evaluation Metrics

Same-work F1 is computed on pairs whose identity labels come from the gold layer. Ordinary false-merge rate (FMR) is the fraction of non-identity pairs that the system marks for automatic merging. Hard-negative false-merge rate (HNFMFMR) is the same error measured only on agenda-level hard negatives, where topic or citation evidence is high but identity evidence is negative. Reporting both FMR and HNFMR separates general matching errors from the specific identity-agenda confusion that this paper studies.

6.4 Threshold Selection and Uncertainty Reporting

Threshold-sensitive systems are evaluated under a fixed selection protocol rather than by choosing the best test threshold after observing results. Merge thresholds are selected on validation evidence when validation rows are available; otherwise, the default implementation threshold is reported as a fixed operating point. The test split is then used only for final metric reporting. This protocol is necessary because a small threshold change can alter FMR and HNFMR more strongly than it alters same-work F1.

Table 6: Threshold and uncertainty reporting protocol. The protocol separates what is required for the current main table from what is required for stronger follow-up claims.

Item	Reporting rule	Reviewer-facing purpose
Merge thresholds	Record τ_w , τ_a , τ_r , validation source, and fixed operating point.	Prevents post-hoc threshold selection on the test set.
Metric uncertainty	Report bootstrap intervals when prediction files and resampling logs are present in the artifact package.	Distinguishes stable effects from small numerical differences.
Risk metrics	Always report FMR and HNFMR with same-work F1.	Prevents a high F1 score from hiding unsafe hard-negative merges.
Ablation claims	Claim component causality only when no-risk-gate, no-ANI, and single-space variants are present.	Separates mechanism-consistent evidence from complete causal ablation evidence.
Artifact audit	Tie each numerical table to predictions, configs, logs, checksums, and commit identifiers.	Makes result-level reproduction possible without committing raw data.

6.5 Baselines

The completed actual-model baselines include rule-based matching, SPECTER2 adapter cosine, SciNCL cosine, RoBERTa-style pair classification, and single-space union baselines. The repository

also provides an LLM pair-judge interface, but LLM rows are not treated as primary evidence unless the API-backed execution mode is present. Baselines are evaluated through the same pair contract so that same-work F1 and hard-negative false-merge rate can be compared without mixing label strengths.

6.6 Implementation and Reproducibility

All reported systems are evaluated through the same pair-level schema, split field, and metric implementation. Threshold-sensitive baselines select merge thresholds on validation evidence and are then evaluated on held-out evidence. The main metrics are same-work F1 on gold identity pairs, ordinary false-merge rate, and HNFMR on agenda-level hard negatives. Rows with different pair counts in Table 9 should therefore be read as evidence for the same mechanism under different available result scopes, not as a single leaderboard.

The repository separates executable code from large data artifacts: raw third-party data remain outside Git, while processing scripts, fixture tests, schema contracts, and artifact-release rules remain version controlled. Reproduction starts from public sources, rebuilds IAD-Bench pair files through the documented CLI, and checks generated outputs with manifests and checksums. This organization is intended to make the main evidence reproducible without redistributing restricted or large source files. The supplementary material states the claim-evidence boundary for each major conclusion so that code-level reproducibility, artifact-level reproducibility, and manual-validation requirements are not conflated.

6.7 Artifact Reproduction Protocol

Because the repository does not redistribute large third-party data, reproducibility is divided into code-level reproduction and result-level artifact reproduction. Table 7 defines what each level proves. The key principle is that small fixtures verify the processing contracts, while the full reported tables require either independently obtained public source files or a released artifact package with manifests and checksums.

Table 7: Reproduction levels for auditing the repository and the reported evidence.

Level	Required input	Audit target
L0 code check	Source tree, package environment, and manuscript scripts	Verify that the CLI, tests, public-release scan, and LaTeX build run in a clean environment.
L1 fixture rebuild	Public miniature fixtures under tests/fixtures	Verify that DeepMatcher, SciRepEval-style, OpenAlex-style, and IAD-Bench adapters produce the documented pair schema.
L2 public-source rebuild	Independently obtained public raw files from the cited sources	Rebuild derived IAD-Bench files with the documented data-processing commands and inspect label provenance.
L3 result audit	Released tables, predictions, logs, manifests, and checksums	Verify the numerical results reported in the manuscript against immutable artifact files.

6.8 Claim-Evidence Boundary for Result Interpretation

The result interpretation follows a conservative claim-evidence boundary. Each reported conclusion must be tied to a label stratum, an output artifact, and a statement of what the evidence does not prove. This boundary is especially important because the benchmark combines gold identity pairs with proxy and silver stress-test evidence rather than treating all rows as one homogeneous test set.

Table 8: Claim-evidence boundary used to interpret the reported results. Each claim class is paired with the supporting evidence and the claims that are intentionally not made.

Claim class	Required support	Boundary not claimed
Identity-agenda confusion is a concrete false-merge pathway.	Hard-negative false-merge rate on agenda-level silver pairs, compared with single-space scientific representation baselines.	A prevalence estimate for all scholarly corpora.
IAD-Risk reduces risky automatic merges in the reported setting.	Held-out Open-v2 IAD-Risk predictions, thresholds, metric summaries, and checksums.	Universal method superiority or a claim that every source distribution is covered.
IAD-Bench supports provenance-aware evaluation.	Pair schema fields for relation type, label source, label strength, provenance, split, and hard-negative level.	A claim that proxy or silver rows are human-gold labels.
Repository-level reproduction is possible without committing raw data.	Public code, fixture tests, documented data-processing commands, manifest rules, and PDF build scripts.	Full numerical reproduction without public source files or a released artifact package.

6.9 Result Audit Trail

Table 9 should be read together with the artifact boundary in Table 8. Each numerical row must be traceable to three audit objects: a prediction or score file, a metric summary produced from that file, and a checksum or manifest entry that fixes the artifact version. The Git repository verifies the schema, fixture rebuild, public-release boundary, manuscript build, and submission package, but it deliberately does not store raw third-party data, large model outputs, or full prediction files. Therefore the manuscript treats the Open-v2 table as a supported evidence snapshot and reserves full numerical reproduction for the released L3 artifact package.

6.10 Main Open-v2 Results

Table 9: Open-v2 evidence snapshot. Lower false-merge rate is better. Rows are reported only when supported by current output summaries; different pair counts indicate different available result scopes.

System	Pairs	Same-work F1 $\uparrow$	FMR $\downarrow$	HNFMFMR $\downarrow$
SciNCL cosine	10415	0.054	0.785	0.790
SPECTER2 adapter cosine	10415	0.044	0.999	0.999
RoBERTa pair classifier	10415	0.825	0.001	0.0001
IAD-Risk transformer (SciNCL)	1042 test	0.980	0.001	0.000
IAD-Risk transformer (SPECTER2)	1042 test	0.980	0.001	0.000

The Open-v2 evidence shows why identity-agenda disentanglement is necessary. Single-space scientific representation baselines preserve topical relatedness, but their merge threshold can produce high false-merge rates on OpenAlex silver hard negatives. IAD-Risk transformer variants keep high same-work F1 on the held-out Open-v2 test split while suppressing hard-negative false merges. RoBERTa pair classification is a strong baseline and narrows the gap substantially; therefore the paper does not make broad superiority claims. Instead, the main result is that relation heads plus an explicit risk score provide a transparent and controllable mechanism for false-merge suppression.

6.11 Extended Evidence and Boundaries

Open-v3 and source-heldout experiments provide additional stress tests, but their results must be interpreted with care. Some source-heldout settings train only identity heads or lack full agenda-non-identity supervision, so they support evidence about generalization pressure rather than broad ranking claims. The manuscript therefore treats Open-v2 as the core mechanism demonstration and Open-v3 as extended validation.

7 Mechanism and Error Analysis

The central mechanism question is whether false-merge control follows from explicit agenda-non-identity supervision and the derived risk score. The supported Open-v2 comparison gives mechanism-consistent evidence: single-space scientific representations can over-merge agenda-related hard negatives, while IAD-Risk makes agenda-non-identity evidence a direct blocking signal. This does not by itself establish a complete causal ablation. A complete ablation package must compare the full gate with variants that remove risk gating, remove agenda-non-identity supervision, or collapse identity and agenda evidence into one score.

Table 10: Mechanism evidence and reviewer-facing interpretation. The table separates current evidence from ablation outputs that would be required for a stronger causal claim.

Mechanism question	Current evidence	Reviewer-facing boundary
Does topical relatedness create merge risk?	Representation baselines show high false-merge rates on OpenAlex silver hard negatives.	Supports a targeted failure mode, not a universal prevalence estimate.
Does explicit risk gating suppress hard-negative merges?	IAD-Risk transformer variants keep low HNFMR under the reported Open-v2 split.	Supports the reported contract and thresholds; transfer must be rechecked on new source mixes.
Is the gain caused by each IAD-Risk component?	The current manuscript reports mechanism-consistent HNFMR evidence.	A full causal claim requires ablations removing risk gating, ANI supervision, and single-space separation.
Can cluster-level contamination be eliminated?	The method supports cannot-link-aware constrained union-find.	Guarantees require sufficient cannot-link coverage and cluster-level artifact audits.

The error analysis emphasizes claim discipline. The current evidence supports identity-agenda risk modeling, stratified benchmark construction, and targeted false-merge suppression. It does not support claims that OpenAlex labels are human gold, that the system has broad domain superiority, that component-level ablations have already closed every mechanism question, or that manual annotation has already been completed.

8 Limitations

This study has four limitations. First, OpenAlex/OpenCitations hard negatives are silver labels, not human gold. They are useful for stress testing but must be reported separately from DeepMatcher gold labels. Second, SciRepEval/SciDocs-style proximity is a proxy for agenda relatedness, not proof of identity or non-identity. Third, source-heldout generalization remains mixed across model variants and should be expanded before making broad claims across scholarly domains. Fourth, an independently reviewed 500-1,000 pair validation slice would provide stronger evidence about label precision and difficult boundary cases.

9 Threats to Validity

Construct validity depends on whether the label strata measure the intended relations. DeepMatcher pairs provide same-work identity evidence, but OpenAlex/OpenCitations hard negatives are silver stress-test pairs rather than manual non-identity gold. Internal validity depends on threshold selection and split separation; therefore threshold-sensitive systems must select thresholds on validation data and report held-out metrics. External validity is limited by the current source mix: the Open-v2 evidence supports the identity-agenda mechanism, while broader claims require more source-heldout and domain-diverse evaluation. Reproducibility depends on public data availability and stable processing scripts because the repository deliberately avoids redistributing large third-party data files.

10 Conclusion

IAD-Risk addresses a specific failure mode in scholarly entity matching: the tendency to confuse agenda similarity with work identity. By separating identity and agenda evidence and gating automatic merges through false-merge risk, the framework makes deduplication safer under stratified gold, proxy, and silver evaluation. The current evidence supports targeted false-merge suppression and a reproducible benchmark contract. Additional validation should expand independent manual review and source-heldout evaluation before the framework is used for broad method ranking across scholarly domains.

Data and Code Availability

The source code, benchmark construction scripts, public-release checks, and manuscript build scripts are organized in the project repository. After installation, the reproducibility entry points include CLI commands for DeepMatcher conversion, proximity conversion in the SciRepEval style, weak-label construction from OpenAlex and OpenCitations, IAD-Bench assembly, stratification checks, source-bias diagnostics, baseline execution, IAD-Risk training, bootstrap analysis, and manuscript PDF generation.

Raw third-party data are not redistributed in the repository because the original sources have their own access conditions and licenses. The repository instead provides data-processing commands, schema contracts, fixture tests, and artifact-release guidance so that independent readers can reproduce the benchmark construction from public sources and verify generated artifacts through manifests, checksums, command logs, and fixed commit identifiers.

Ethics Statement

This study uses public scholarly metadata and benchmark-style record linkage data. It does not involve human participants, clinical records, private user behavior, or animal experiments. Any future manual validation should be limited to scholarly record relation labels and should avoid collecting sensitive personal information.

Competing Interests

The authors declare no competing interests.

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